



Mid-Program Review

The 360° of Program Management

Bosch

20-04-2026

Introduction

Some indicators:

Participant Name : Mohana Krishna M
Manager Name : Nair Ashok Sivasankaran
Role : Project Manager
Function/Department : MS/EAN41 MM

What is your job role? What activities does it involve?

- My current role is a Mechanical Project Manager, where I am responsible for managing end-to-end product development and delivery.
- My role involves planning, execution, and monitoring of projects across different phases—from concept to production. I work closely with cross-functional teams such as design, manufacturing, quality, and procurement to ensure alignment with project goals.
- Key activities include defining project scope, creating timelines, and tracking progress against milestones. I also manage risks and issues proactively, ensuring mitigation plans are in place to avoid delays.
- Overall, my focus is on delivering projects within scope, time, and quality while maintaining effective communication across global teams.

Who is your customer? (e.g: Internal teams or external clients) – Internal Bosch

Instructions for the Program Reflection

Prework:

- Each participant is requested to reflect on their own work experience and **cite instances** where learning from the various modules in the program covered so far could be applied in real work-life situations to improve outcomes. Please include real examples and not generic statements
- Do call out at least one mindset shift you have experienced
- Please also present your learnings from coaching sessions
- Please feel free to make this **ppt creative, add animation, images etc** that will help you create a buy-in with the panellists.



Module-wise Learning Application



Modules		Been able to apply	Identified areas to apply	No Scope to apply
Leadership	Leader in me		✓	
	Resilient Leadership		✓	
	Uncertainty Management		✓	
	Strategic Thinking & Creativity	✓		
Professional	Leading Cross-functional teams	✓		
	Negotiation Skills/Conflict Management	✓		

Note : Use the tick symbol to mark your relevant responses



Module-wise Learning Application



Modules		Been able to apply	Identified areas to apply	No Scope to apply
Functional	AI & Program Management	✓		
	Resource Optimization Tools	✓		
	Advanced Financial Metrics & KPI's			✓

Note : Use the tick symbol to mark your relevant responses

Application of Learnings from Leadership Modules

Strategic Thinking and Creativity

Learning : Blue Ocean Strategy

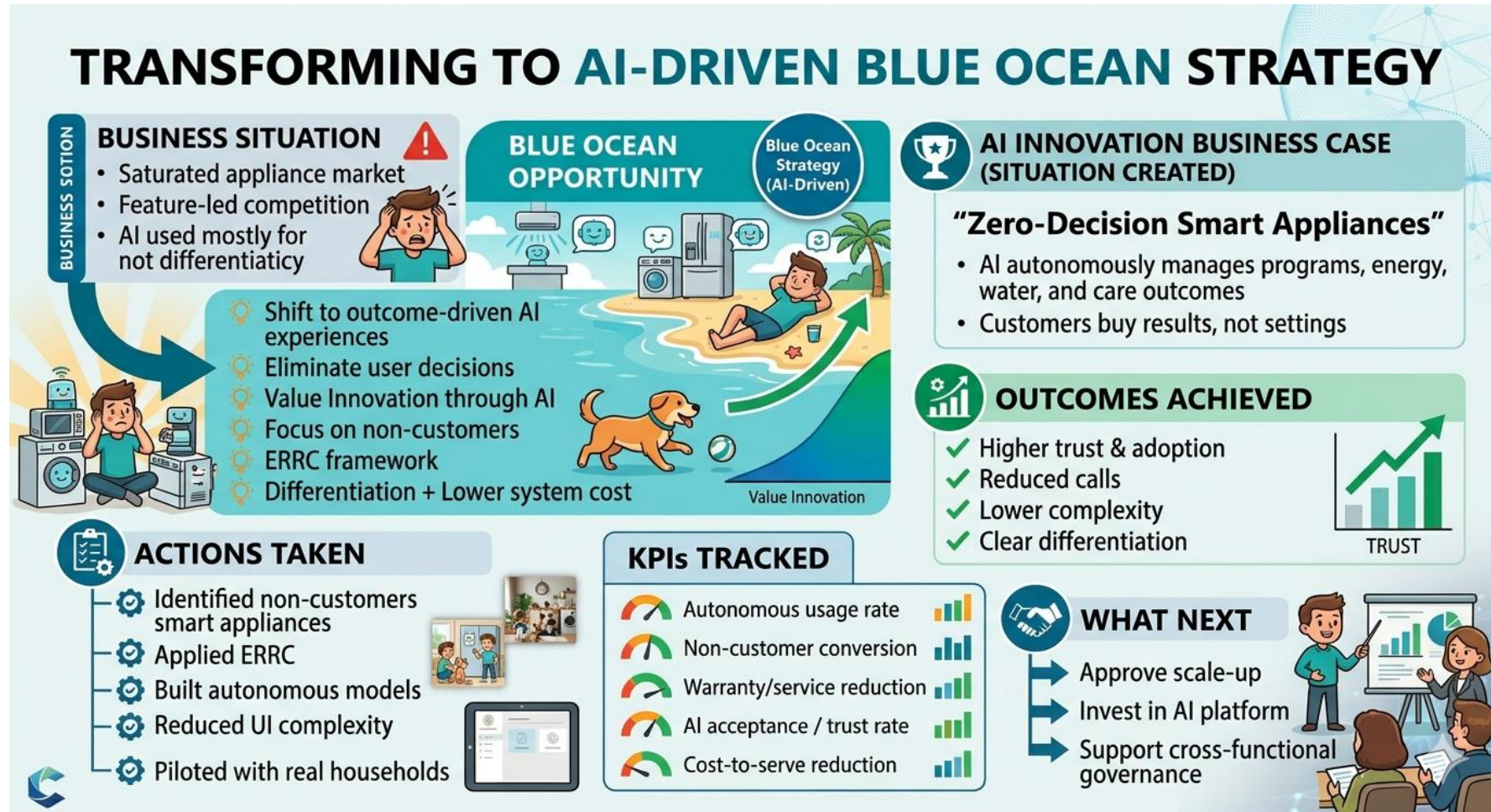
Current situation on BSH:

In the saturated global appliance market, manufacturers are trapped in a cycle of feature-led competition and high UI complexity because they prioritize technical specs over user outcomes, resulting in stagnant growth and high "cost-to-serve" that can only be overcome by shifting to autonomous, zero-decision AI experiences.

The Situation (The Red Ocean)	The Strategy (The Blue Ocean)	Strategic Actions	Expected Outcomes
The home appliance market is currently defined by commoditization and thin margins. Competitors are fighting over incremental features, leading to "feature fatigue" where users find smart appliances too complex for daily use.	By integrating AI as a core mechanical and digital driver, BSH can move away from selling "tools" to providing "effortless living." • Eliminate: Manual mode selection and complex physical interfaces. • Reduce: Maintenance stress and resource waste (water/energy). • Raise: Personalization through learning user habits. • Create: Autonomous operations and predictive service models.	Autonomous Brewing & Cooking: Using sensors and AI to adjust parameters in real-time (e.g., coffee grind size adjusted for bean density). Predictive Life-Cycle Management: Edge AI that monitors mechanical health and schedules its own maintenance before a failure occurs. Generative Mechanical Design: Using AI to optimize the internal mechanics of appliances for maximum durability and brewing efficiency.	Premium Positioning: Establishing a 20-25% price premium justified by the "convenience as a service" model. Ecosystem Lock-in: Moving from a one-time purchase to a lifetime relationship through integrated AI services and subscriptions. Operational Agility: Faster R&D cycles using AI-driven generative design for mechanical components.
Strategy Summary for BSH			

Application of Learnings from Leadership Modules

Strategic Thinking and Creativity



Application of Learnings from Professional Modules

Negotiation

AI-Driven Blue Ocean Innovation at BSH

1. Business Situation (Scenario Setup)

BSH launches a Blue Ocean AI initiative:

“Zero-Decision Smart Appliances” — AI autonomously manages programs, energy, water, and care outcomes.

The initiative requires deep cross-functional alignment across:

- Product Development
- Digital / AI Team
- UX & Design
- Manufacturing
- Service & Quality
- Legal & Data Privacy
- Finance / Controlling

Resolving Conflicts During Scale-Up



2. Conflict Situation Emerges -Trigger Event

During scale-up decision, conflicts arise between teams:

Conflict 1: Product vs AI Team

Product Team Concern

--We'll lose hardware differentiation and brand identity.

AI Team Stand

--AI-defined outcomes require reducing variants and UI complexity.

Conflict 2: Manufacturing vs UX

Manufacturing

--Reducing hardware variants impacts supplier contracts and plants.

UX

--Complex UIs break the core Blue Ocean promise.

Conflict 3: Legal / Data Privacy vs Innovation

Legal

--Continuous learning AI adds data and compliance risk.

Innovation Lead

--Without learning, AI becomes a Red Ocean feature.

Application of Learnings from Professional Modules

Negotiation

AI-Driven Blue Ocean Innovation at BSH

3. Negotiation Objective (Manager / Innovation Lead)

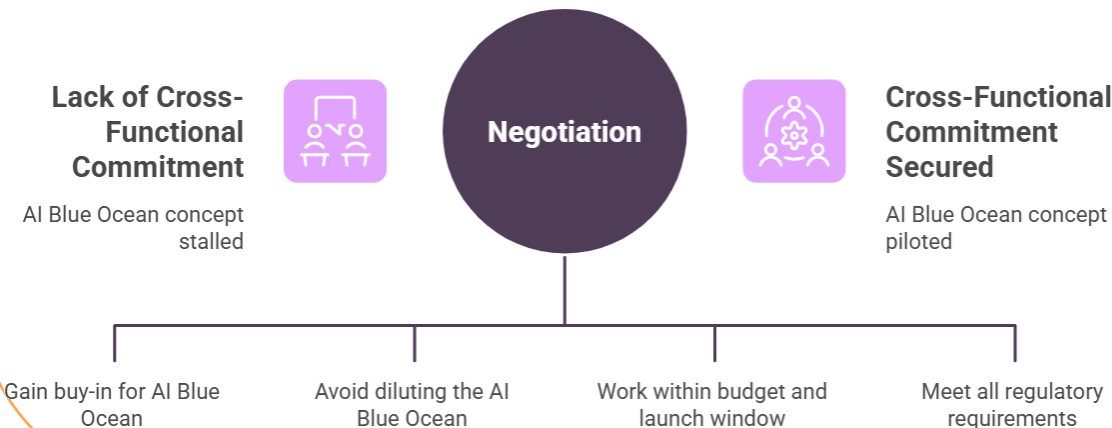
🎯 Goal:

Secure cross-functional commitment to pilot and scale the AI Blue Ocean concept without diluting strategy.

Constraints:

- Limited budget
- Fixed product launch window
- Regulatory compliance mandatory

Securing Cross-Functional Commitment for AI Blue Ocean



4. BATNA Framework Application

Define BATNA for Each Stakeholder

A) Innovation Lead (my self)

BATNA:

Scale AI only as a software-only pilot on one product line

Prove ROI → return with evidence

✅ Weak but viable fallback

B) Product Development

BATNA:

Retain current HW differentiation

Add AI as optional feature (Red Ocean approach)

Risk: Loses strategic edge

C) Manufacturing

BATNA:

Continue existing SKU complexity

Accept higher cost baseline

Risk: Long-term inefficiency

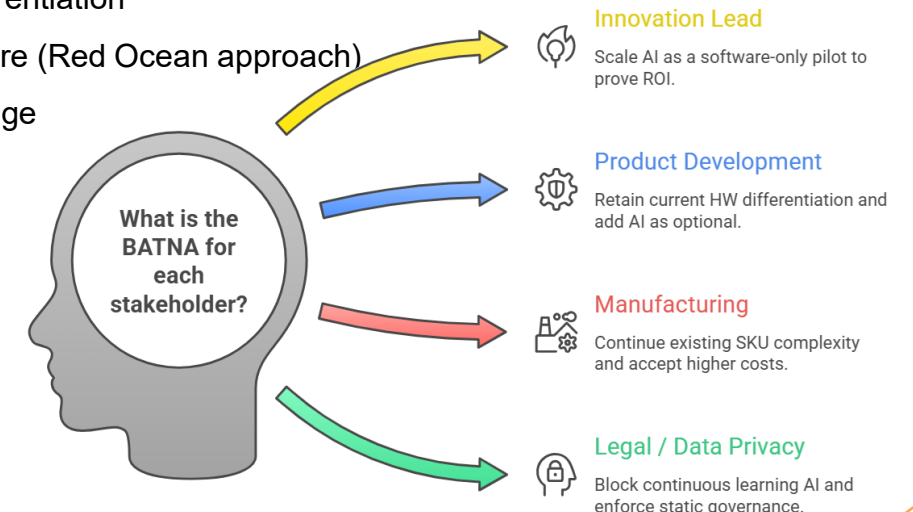
D) Legal / Data Privacy

BATNA:

Block continuous learning AI

Enforce static model governance

Risk: AI stagnation



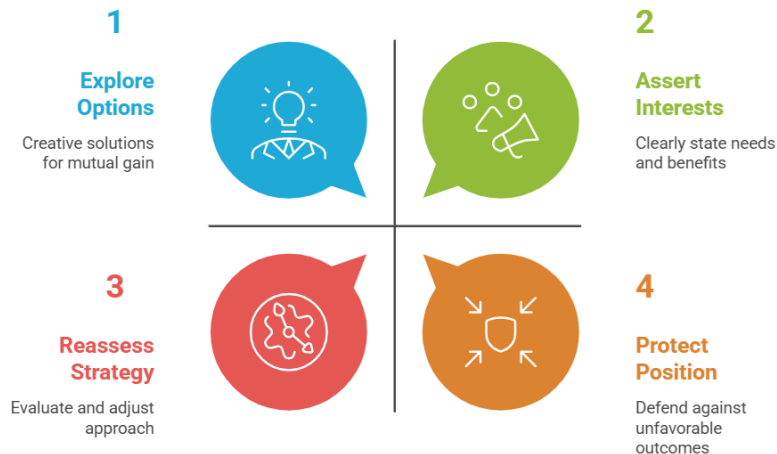
Application of Learnings from Professional Modules

Negotiation

The Power of Collaborative Negotiation



Negotiate with BATNA



AI-Driven Blue Ocean Innovation at BSH

5. Negotiation Strategy (Interest-Based, Not Position-Based)

Shift the Discussion

From: “Who gives up what?”

To: “How do we win safely together?”

6. Negotiation Moves Using BATNA

Move 1: Make BATNAs Explicit (Without Threatening)

◆ Innovation Lead Statement“

If we cannot align now, we will pilot on one line only.

That protects timelines—but all teams lose scale benefits.

✓ Signals BATNA clearly, without conflict.

Move 2: Reframe Value for Each Function

Team	Reframed Win
Product	AI becomes new brand DNA, not hardware
Mfg	Fewer variants = cost & quality stability
UX	Simpler UI = higher adoption
Legal	Governed learning zones, not open data

✓ Focus on interests, not positions.

Move 3:

Create Multiple Options (Avoid Fixed Positions)

Instead of Yes/No, propose options:

- Limited learning AI sandbox
- Region-specific data models
- AI explainability layer for service & legal

✓ Creativity under constraint

Application of Learnings from Professional Modules

Conflict Management

AI-Driven Blue Ocean Innovation at BSH

7. Conflict Management Techniques Applied

Technique 1: Separate People from Problem

- No “blocking team” narrative
- Problem = system tension, not individuals

Technique 2: Objective Criteria

- KPIs from dashboard:
 - Autonomous usage rate
 - Service reduction
 - Warranty claims
- Data beat's opinion

Technique 3: Fair Process

- All functions involved early in design trade-offs
- Transparent governance

The Power of Integrated Conflict Management

1
Separate People from Problem
Focus on issues, not personalities



2
Objective Criteria
Use data to guide decisions


Data-Driven Objectivity
Decisions based on facts, not emotions

8. Negotiated Agreement (Outcome)

✓ Agreed Solution

Pilot AI Blue Ocean on one product platform

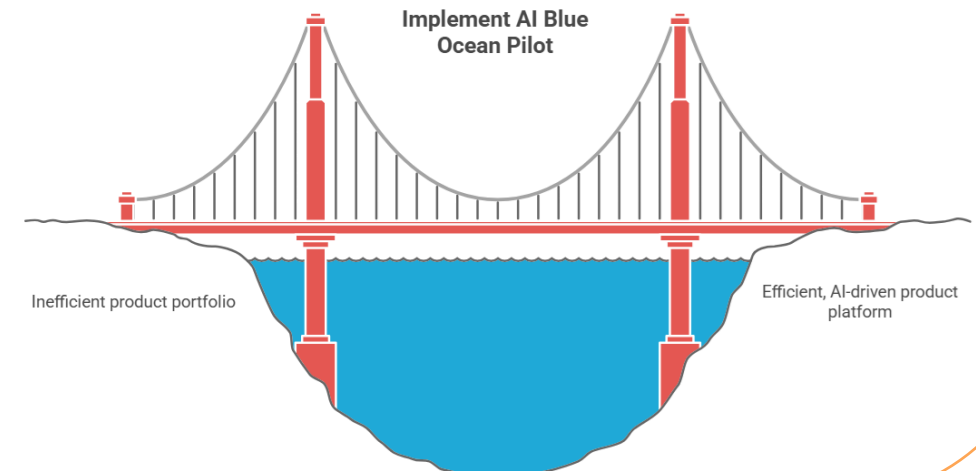
Reduce variants by 20%

Introduce AI learning in controlled lifecycle phases

Governance board with Legal + Innovation

Scale decision after 6 months with KPI review

Negotiated Agreement: AI Blue Ocean Pilot Reduces Variants



Application of Learnings from Professional Modules

Conflict Management AI-Driven Blue Ocean Innovation at BSH

9. Outcomes (Business + People)

Business Outcomes

- Blue Ocean strategy preserved
- Reduced time-to-decision
- Shared ownership of results

Capability Development

- Stronger negotiation maturity
- Conflict seen as design input, not resistance
- BATNA awareness improved leadership effectiveness

10. Learning Summary

Effective AI innovation leadership at BSH requires negotiating value trade-offs across functions using BATNA—protecting strategy while enabling safe execution, rather than forcing alignment.

Managing Uncertainty in AI-Driven Blue Ocean Innovation

Context



Zero-Decision Smart Appliances
Shift from Features to Outcome-Driven

Sources of Uncertainty

Market



Technology



Regulatory



Behavior



Trigger Event



Unexpected Signals, Decision Point
"Scale, Pivot, or Pause?"

Risk vs. Uncertainty

Risk

- ✓ Known Variables
- ✓ Uncertainty

Uncertainty

- ☁ Unknown Future
- ☁ Unknown Single

Strategic Options

- ↑ Phased Scale-Up
- ↑ Learning Trust Zones
- ↑ Service Anomalies

Scenarios

Optimistic



Moderate



Adverse



Early Warning Indicators



Monthly "Uncertainty Review"
Cross-Functional Team

Outcome

Strategic

- ✓ Controlled Scale-Up
- ✓ Stay Flexible

Capability

- 💡 Comfort with Ambiguity
- 💡 Faster Learning

Strategic Options

Strong Leader

- 👤 Embrace Learning
- 👤 Stay Flexible

Weak Leader

- 👤 Demand Certainty
- 👤 Avoid Decisions

Key Learning: From Prediction to Preparedness

Application of Learnings from Professional Modules

Uncertainty Management

Scenario: Managing Uncertainty in AI-Driven Innovation at BSH

1. Strategic Context (From Your Blue Ocean AI Strategy)

Strategic intent :

BSH is executing a Blue Ocean AI strategy to move from feature-led appliances to outcome-driven, zero-decision smart appliances, where AI autonomously manages programs, energy, water, and care outcomes

This is not incremental innovation — it is a market-space shift, which inherently introduces high uncertainty.

2. Sources of Uncertainty (Structured Identification)

Unlike traditional risk (known, quantifiable), this initiative faces deep uncertainty.

Key Uncertainty Categories

Category	Uncertainty Description
Market Uncertainty	Will customers trust AI enough to give up control?
Behavioral Uncertainty	Will users override AI decisions?
Regulatory Uncertainty	How will data privacy requirements evolve?
Technology Uncertainty	Will AI models perform consistently in real-world conditions?
Organizational Uncertainty	Will functions align or protect silos?
Economic Uncertainty	Can cost reductions be realized at scale?

✅ Leadership requirement: Manage unknowns, not just risks.

3. Trigger Event (Scenario Start)

During SteerCo review after pilot approval, unexpected signals emerge:

- Early pilots show high AI trust — but only in certain user segments
- Legal flags future AI learning constraints
- Manufacturing reports supplier resistance to variant reduction
- Finance questions ROI predictability beyond pilot scale

Decision required:

👉 Scale, pivot, slow down, or stop?

This is a classic uncertainty management moment.

4. Uncertainty Management Approach (Step-by-Step)

Step 1: Distinguish Risk vs Uncertainty

Risk	Uncertainty
Model accuracy variance	Customer trust evolution
Service cost savings	Regulatory interpretation changes
Pilot cost overrun	Will Blue Ocean value sustain at scale?

✅ Stop forcing false precision. ✅ Treat uncertainty explicitly.

Step 2: Use Scenarios Instead of Single Forecasts

AI Blue Ocean Scenarios at BSH

Scenario	Description
Optimistic	High trust, fast adoption, strong cost reduction
Moderate (Base)	Gradual adoption, segment-specific success
Adverse	AI skepticism, regulatory slowdown

✅ Leadership shifts from “What will happen?” to “What do we do if this happens?”

Application of Learnings from Professional Modules

Scenario: Managing Uncertainty in AI-Driven Innovation at BSH

Uncertainty Management

5. Strategic Options (Flexibility, Not Commitment)

Instead of a binary scale / stop decision, leadership creates real options.

Option Set

Option	Purpose
Phased scale-up by region	Limits exposure
AI learning "trust zones"	Reduces regulatory risk
Manual override logging	Builds explainability
Modular HW platform	Preserves flexibility

- ✓ This converts uncertainty into design input.

6. Early Warning Indicators (EWIs)

To manage uncertainty proactively, the team defines EWIs instead of classic KPIs.

Examples of EWIs

Signal	Interpretation
AI override frequency ↑	Trust erosion
Service call pattern shift	AI logic gaps
Legal queries frequency ↑	Regulatory concern
UX complaints clustering	Complexity leak

- ✓ Decisions triggered by signals, not surprises.

7. Governance Model for Uncertainty

Adaptive Governance Structure

- Monthly AI Uncertainty Review
- Cross-functional participation (Product, AI, Legal, Service)
- Focus on:
 - What new unknowns emerged?
 - What assumptions no longer hold?

- ✓ Prevents "late-stage firefighting".

8. Leadership Behavior in Uncertainty (Key Skill Development)

What Strong Leaders Do

- ✓ Say "We don't know yet" — transparently
- ✓ Keep decision reversible where possible
- ✓ Invest in learning velocity, not certainty
- ✓ Protect strategy while allowing tactical adjustment

What Weak Leaders Do

- ✗ Force fixed ROI numbers
- ✗ Delay decisions waiting for certainty
- ✗ Treat uncertainty as failure

Application of Learnings from Professional Modules

Uncertainty Management

Scenario: Managing Uncertainty in AI-Driven Innovation at BSH

9. Outcome of the Scenario

Strategic Outcome

- AI Blue Ocean strategy remains intact
- Scale-up proceeds in controlled waves
- Organization builds confidence handling ambiguity

Capability Outcome

- Teams become comfortable operating with incomplete information
- Uncertainty becomes managed, not feared
- Faster, better strategic decisions under ambiguity

10. Learning Summary (PMDP / Leadership Ready)

Uncertainty management in AI-driven Blue Ocean innovation at BSH means shifting from prediction to preparedness—using scenarios, early signals, flexibility, and adaptive governance instead of false certainty.

11. How You Can Use This Practically

You can directly use this scenario for:

- ✓ Leadership / PMDP evidence (Uncertainty Management)
- ✓ Role-play or training session
- ✓ SteerCo discussion framing
- ✓ Innovation review gate justification

Action Plan (Next 30–60 Days)

3 specific actions you will take:

Functional:

1. AI & Program Management: Learn AI tools, Develop AI based use case in BSH project
2. Create Business case for AI
3. Resource Optimization tools: Analyze team utilization (Target > 90%).

How will you measure success?

Driving new product development efficiency by applying an AI-based innovation framework for optimal resource utilization.

The background of the slide is a dark, textured surface with a pattern of diagonal lines in shades of brown and gold. Scattered across these lines are numerous small, glowing yellow and orange particles, giving the impression of a digital or scientific environment.

Thank You